Freelance Agreement

Welcome to Lead Stories, an award-winning, innovative, fact checking and debunking website at the intersection of big data and journalism that developed alongside the need to help combat misinformation. Given the nature of the work and the size of the team, these terms and conditions must be adhered to by all.

Terms

Your work with Lead Stories is on an "at will" basis, meaning that either you or Lead Stories may terminate your freelance work at any time for any reason or no reason. Lead Stories also reserves the right to modify or amend the terms of your work at any time for any reason.

Professional Standards

You shall adhere to the highest professional and ethical standards of the fact checking profession.

- At all times, you will follow guidelines set by Lead Stories, the International Fact Checking Network and the European Fact-Checking Standards Network.

Responsibilities

Whenever you are engaged in fact-checking work for Lead Stories, you must adhere to the following principles:

- Employ impartial journalistic methods and a transparent approach to evidence so that your personal biases do not undermine the accuracy of your work.
- Complete fact checks in a timely manner.
- Back up your fact checks with proper and credible sources.
- Keep editors in the loop about any issues that arise or questions you have as soon as possible.
- Keep a record of all of your work in your Google Doc or Spreadsheet supplied by Lead Stories.

- No lifting or plagiarizing content from other news organizations. You must provide attribution.
- No use of AI to write fact checks.

Confidentiality and Proprietary Information

During the terms of this agreement, you may have access to and/or become acquainted with proprietary content and other related information, which may consist of story ideas, sources, contacts, records, files, and other information. All proprietary information shall remain exclusive property of Lead Stories; all proprietary information shall be deemed confidential. Under no circumstance are you allowed to make copies and/or share any proprietary information with anyone outside the company, including former staff members and freelancers.

*Any willful violation of this will be terms for immediate termination and potential legal action.

Files and Records

All files and records relating in any manner whatsoever to the business of Lead Stories shall remain the exclusive property of Lead Stories regardless of who acquired or initially prepared the original file.

*Any willful violation of this will be terms for immediate termination and potential legal action.

Communication

Use only your LeadStories email address to email your managers and colleagues. You may not use this email address to represent yourself in a personal or professional manner not related to your work at Lead Stories.

Respect your colleagues' privacy. Some of your colleagues work under difficult circumstances. Do not share the names or location of your colleagues. That means, you don't share your colleagues' names, locations or duties with anyone outside of the company. Any violation of this is considered breach and will result in immediate termination.

Use the LS Slack channels to conduct work-related conversations. While we want the team to speak with one another, we will not tolerate unprofessional behavior in the channels.

You may contact your managers via Signal or WhatsApp.

Describing Your Work

You can tell people you work for Lead Stories, and you work on the TT fact check project. This is public knowledge. You may not tell people how the work is done, and who works on the project.

Social Media

Follow IFCN standards when it comes to social media and do not engage in partisan posting.

You may not under any circumstances falsely represent yourself nor create false or misleading social media profiles while engaging in work for Lead Stories.

Media

You may not provide to any media organization any details or give interviews about Lead Stories, its policies or practices without prior approval.

Vacation Policy

We require you to provide at least two weeks (14 days) notice when you request time off.

Getting Paid

You are required to complete your WorkMarket entries or file a detailed invoice by the end of the last day of the month. If you are paid via JustWorks, you are required to provide a detailed accounting of your hours and work as detailed in the onboarding process.

I understand that willfully violating any of these terms and conditions is grounds for immediate termination and may result in legal action.

Dilyana Kamchilova — 04/05/2023

Name — Date